

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

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Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: anatomy; biology; organ; food; cooking; laboratory test; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The proposed image shows a full, asymmetrical liver as one broad wedge: a dominant rounded lobe, a smaller tapered lobe, a shallow lower notch, and a short curved lobe mark. A compact gallbladder is nested into the lower contour. Vendors may change the angle, shading, and color, or omit the gallbladder, while preserving the unequal-lobe silhouette at emoji size.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. Anatomy, food, and healthcare are literal uses of the liver, not separate metaphorical meanings.

B. Use in sequences

Liver can combine with existing emoji to make three concise messages:

- Liver + Test Tube: “My liver-test results.”
- Liver + Pill + Warning: “This medicine may affect my liver.”
- Duck + Liver + Fork and Knife: “We’re having duck liver for dinner.”

The National Library of Medicine uses the term “liver function tests” and explains that these tests can check for side effects of medicines that affect the liver.

The U.S. Department of Agriculture lists duck liver among the giblets sold with whole birds, supporting the dinner message as a separate everyday use of the same organ image.

Sources:

- [National Library of Medicine: Liver Function Tests](#)
- [U.S. Department of Agriculture: Duck and Goose from Farm to Table](#)

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. Existing emoji can express a test, medicine warning, meal, or generic meat, but none identifies the liver. Liver adds the missing noun in “my liver-test results,” “this medicine may affect my liver,” and “we’re having duck liver for dinner.”

Reference: [Current Unicode emoji list](#)

D. Distinctiveness

Even at 18x18, the proposed liver keeps one continuous asymmetric wedge: a dominant rounded lobe, a smaller tapered lobe, and a shallow notch underneath. A short curved mark reinforces the lobe change without cutting the organ in half. That shape is not upright like Anatomical Heart, paired like Lungs, round and folded like Brain, marbled like Cut of Meat, or divided into separate Beans. The nested green gallbladder confirms the color image, but the unequal-lobe outline carries the identity in black and white too.

Liver	Anatomical Heart	Lungs	Brain	Cut of Meat	Beans
Color 72 					
Color 18 					
B/W 72 					
B/W 18 					

E. Expected usage level

Liver is a familiar word in anatomy lessons, cooking, and conversations about tests, medicine, donation, and transplantation. Public health pages describe liver anatomy, liver tests, medicine effects, donation, and transplantation. The U.S. Department of Agriculture also identifies duck liver as food. The five figures below measure the word `liver` itself. They show worldwide Web interest comparable to `elephant`, lower but sustained worldwide Image Search interest, and substantially higher recent English-language published-word frequency.

Sources:

- [National Library of Medicine: Liver Function Tests](#)
- [National Library of Medicine: Liver Anatomy](#)
- [U.S. Department of Agriculture: Duck and Goose from Farm to Table](#)
- [National Institutes of Health: Liver Transplant](#)

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google reports about 183,000 results for the unquoted term `liver`.

Open the reproducible Google Search query

The screenshot shows a Google search for the term "liver". The search bar at the top contains the word "liver". To the right of the search bar are icons for settings, sharing, and a "Sign in" button. Below the search bar, the "Tools" menu is open, showing options for "Any time", "All results", and "Advanced Search". The "Advanced Search" option is selected, and it shows "About 183,000 results (0.19s)".

The "AI Overview" section provides a summary of the liver: "The liver is the largest internal organ in the human body, located in the upper right side of the abdomen. It performs over 500 vital jobs, including filtering blood, making bile to digest food, and storing energy." Below this, there is a "Key Functions" section with a "Show more" button.

The search results section shows a result from Cleveland Clinic titled "Liver: Where It's Located, Function & Anatomy". The snippet reads: "Sep 26, 2025 — Your liver is located on the right side of your upper abdomen. Its functions include filtering blood, making chemicals and fighting ...".

Below the search results, there is a "People also ask" section with four questions: "What are the first signs of a bad liver?", "What is the best drink to flush your liver?", "How do I fix liver problems?", and "Where do you feel liver pain?". Each question has a dropdown arrow next to it.

At the bottom, there is a result from Wikipedia titled "Liver". The snippet reads: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which performs many essential biological functions such as detoxification of the organism".

Below the Wikipedia result, there is an "Images" section.

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google Video Search reports about 72,400,000 results.

[Open the reproducible Google Video Search query](#)

Google

liver

Sign in

All Images Books News **Videos** Shopping More

Tools

- Any duration
- Any time
- Any quality
- All videos
- Any source
- Advanced Search

About 72,400,000 results (0.20s)

www.youtube.com › watch

How The Liver Works

For more information about how the liver works, visit: www.clevelandclinic.com/health/conditions/4wVclJE The liver is a large organ in the upper right part of the abdomen.

YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Aug 12, 2024

2:07

4 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Chronic Liver Disease - Yale Medicine Explains

For more information on liver disease or #YaleMedicine, visit: <https://www.yalemedicine.org/conditions/liver-transplant> or ...

YouTube · Yale Medicine · May 2, 2026

4:43

3 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Anatomy and Physiology of the Liver, Animation

the proper hepatic artery carrying oxygenated blood from the aorta, and the hepatic portal vein carrying venous drainage from most of the ...

YouTube · Allila Medical Media · May 1, 2023

5:23

5 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Liver Patient Education Videos: Video 2 The Liver English

At Stanford Medicine Children's Health, our team of pediatric liver doctors (hepatologists) are leaders in treating complex pediatric liver ...

YouTube · Stanford Medicine Children's Health · May 30, 2024

2:20

www.youtube.com › watch

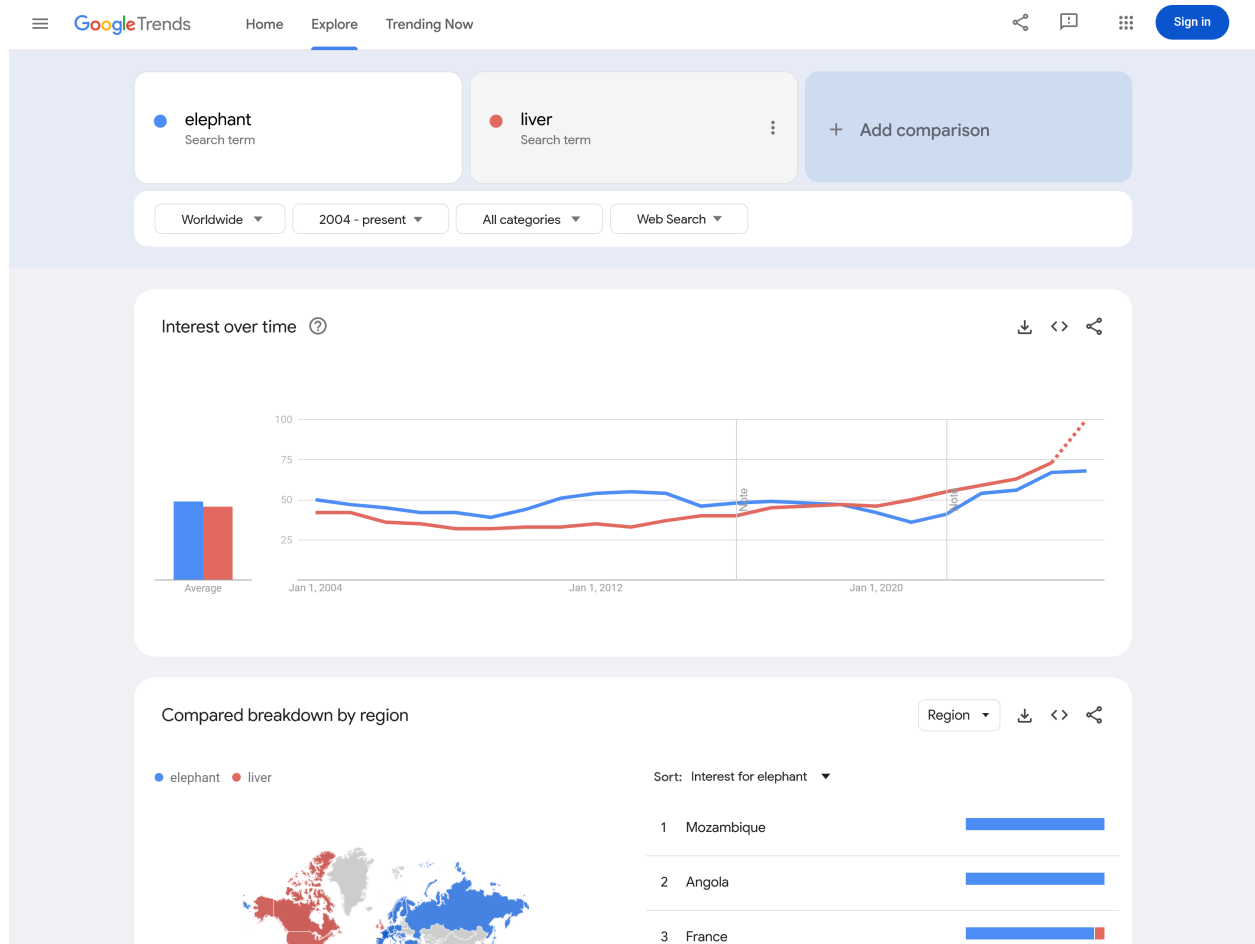
Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors ...

Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors, Symptoms, ...

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, and Web Search. Liver and elephant have comparable average interest across the full period, and liver exceeds elephant in the most recent portion of the graph.

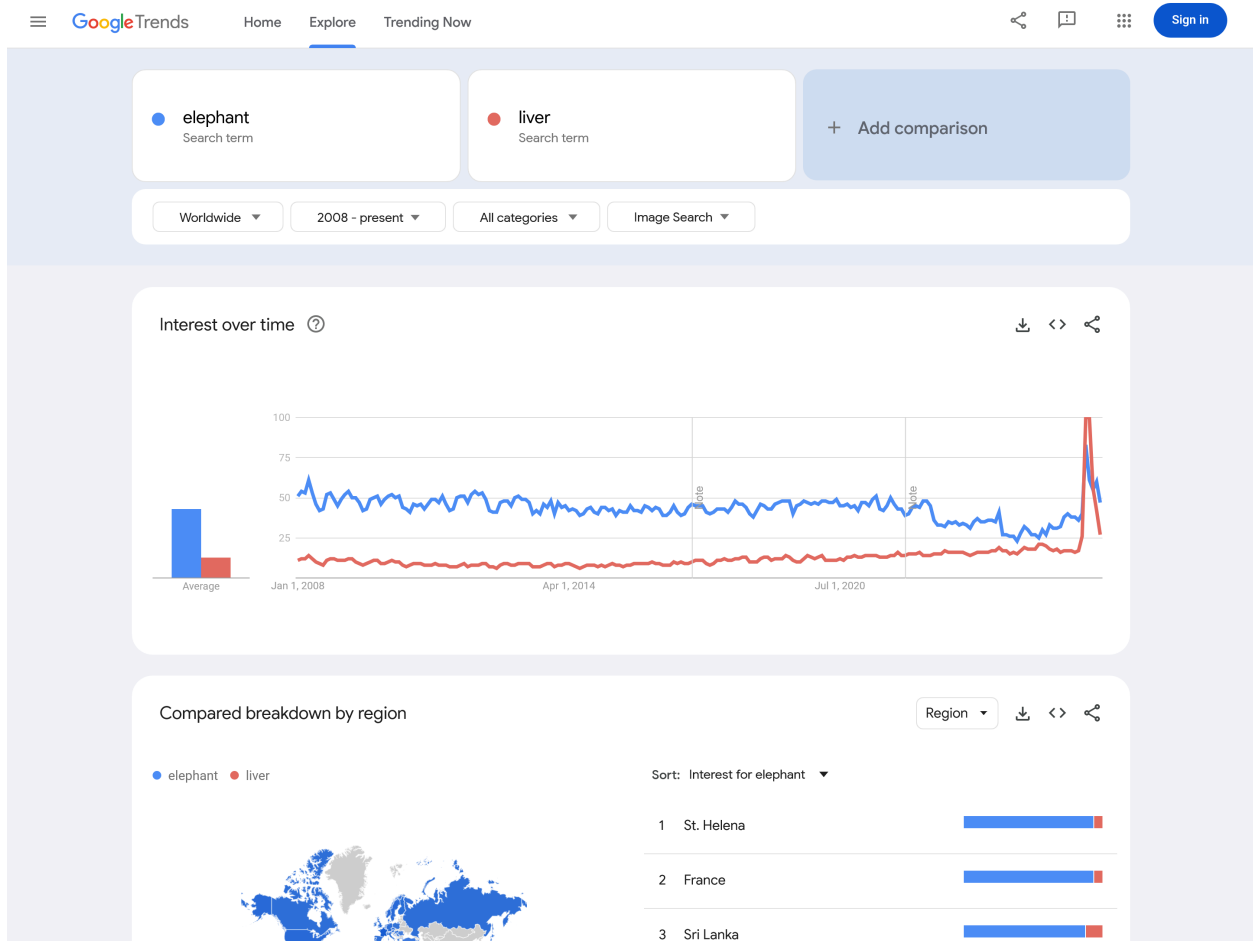
[Open the reproducible Worldwide Web Search comparison](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, and Image Search. Liver remains below elephant in average image-search interest while remaining present across the full period.

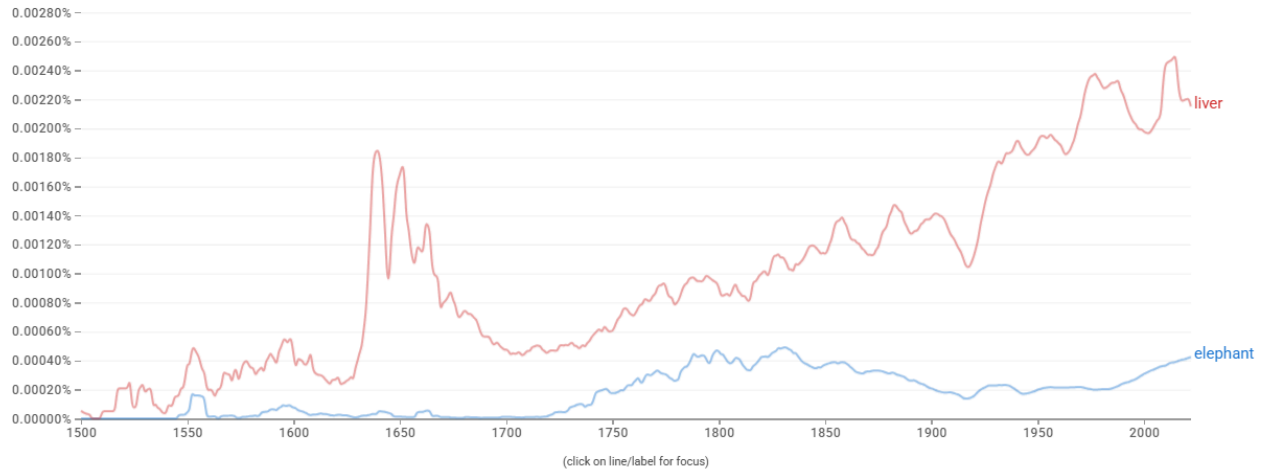
[Open the reproducible Worldwide Image Search comparison](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Liver substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-word frequency.

[Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram comparison](#)



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Anatomy is not a fixed set for this factor.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. No qualifying popular-system pictograph is claimed.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Test Tube, Pill + Warning, and Fork and Knife express the surrounding activity; Duck identifies the animal; Cut of Meat expresses a generic food category. None supplies the noun liver. Without it, the cited messages lose their anatomical or food subject.

B. Overly specific

The proposal is for the whole liver, not a lobe, disease, test result, transplant procedure, specialty, recipe, or campaign. It names a broad organ used in anatomy and biology, food and cooking, and healthcare.

C. Open-ended

Liver is not proposed simply because it is an organ. People use the same word and image in cooking, anatomy, test results, medicine warnings, donation, and transplantation, and the evidence above measures `liver` directly. That case does not depend on completing a set of body parts, foods, tests, diseases, or procedures.

D. Transient

Liver is not tied to a campaign, event, or temporary technology. The English-language Ngram tracks the word through 1500-2022, and current government health and food pages still use it for anatomy, tests, food, and transplantation.

E. Faulty comparison

Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain are shown only as visual and sorting references. Liver is proposed for the sourced messages and frequency evidence above, not because those emoji already exist.

Other Information

Essential design cues are a broad asymmetrical outline, a larger rounded side, a smaller tapered side, and a short curved lobe mark visible at 18x18. The gallbladder, shading, angle, and exact color are optional. Vendors should avoid a rectangular food cut or a featureless filled oval.

[Official Unicode proposal guidance](#)